With this line of thinking in mind, some of the World System theorists use Marxist terminology and Leninist insights to explain this situation of dependency. Here the structural theories of dependency of the two chief proponents will be discussed.

## Immanuel Wallerstein and His World System Theory

Wallerstein represents the most powerful exposition of the modern World System theory in his sem inal work *Modern World System: Capitalist Agriculture and the Origins of the European World-Economy in the Sixteenth Century* (1974). Tracing the emergence of capitalism in the sixteenth century Europe, he examines its evolution into a world capitalist system that contains a **core,** a **periphery** and a **semi-periphery** (see Figure 2.1). The 'core' has come to constitute historically the most advanced economic areas, which are engaged

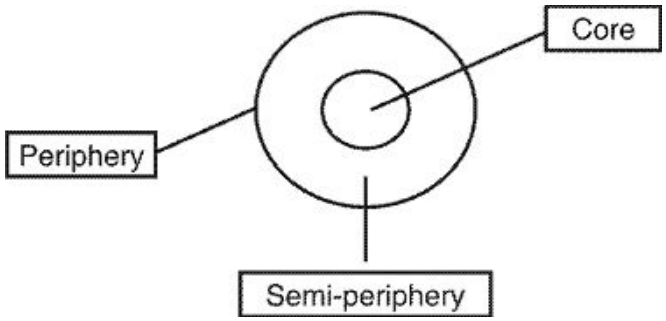



**Figure 2.1 Configuration of the modern world system.**

in activities like banking, manufacturing, technologically advanced agriculture, ship building and others. The 'periphery' has been providing raw materials such as minerals and timber to support the core's economic expansion. Unskilled labour is repressed and the peripheral countries are denied advanced technology from the core countries in those sectors where they may give the core countries a tough competition. The semi-periphery is involved in a mix of production activities, some associated with core areas and others with peripheral areas. It also serves as an outlet for investment when wages in core economies become too high. Over the time, particular regions of the world may gravitate between core, peripheral and semi-peripheral status. Class structure in each zone varies depending on how the dominant class relates to the world economy.